

STRATEGIES TO HELP YOUR CHILD'S COMMUNICATION

IF I:

MY CHILD WILL FEEL/LEARN
TO:

OBSERVE, WAIT, LISTEN

initiate communication
Trust me not to take over

AM FACE TO FACE WITH CHILD

feel valued, important
Make more eye contact
Watch my mouth/gestures

REFRAIN FROM ANTICIPATING
MY CHILD'S NEEDS

not become passive
draw my attention to things
participate more

FOLLOW MY CHILD'S LEAD

not protest my directions
feel valued
be motivated+learn more
have more fun

IMITATE MY CHILD'S ACTIONS
SOUNDS, GESTURES, UNCLEAR
WORDS

take notice of me
learn to imitate me
take more turns
feel message is confirmed

INTERPRET MY CHILD'S ATTEMPTS
TO COMMUNICATE INTO CLEAR
WORDS

feel message is confirmed
know I want to understand
learn to negotiate meaning

OTHER STRATEGIES TO IMPROVE YOUR CHILD'S COMMUNICATION

- FOCUS ON CHILD RATHER THEN ACTIVITY
- MAKE COMMENTS TO CHILD RATHER THAN ASK QUESTIONS
- ASK QUESTION WHICH ARE GENUINE AND GEARED TO CHILD'S LEVEL
- LEAVE PAUSES IN THE MIDDLE OF GAMES, SONGS OR STORIES
- TALK ABOUT WHAT SEEMS TO BE ON THE CHILD'S MIND AT THAT MOMENT
- EMPHASIZE KEY WORDS
- USE GESTURE TO ACCOMPANY SPEECH
- SLOW DOWN
- EXPAND WHAT THE CHILD HAS SAID BY JUST ONE OR TWO WORDS
- TALK TO BROTHERS OR SISTERS IF APPROPRIATE ABOUT HE METHODS USED WITH THE SIBLING WHO HAS DIFFICULTY

ALLOW YOUR CHILD TO LEAD:

OBSERVE

WAIT

LISTEN

ADAPT TO SHARE THE MOMENT:

JOIN IN CHILD'S ACTIVITY

USE SIGNALS

SAY IT IN SIMPLE LANGUAGE

ADD LANGUAGE AND EXPERIENCES:

LABEL

DESCRIBE

GESTURE

SLOW DOWN

EXAGGERATE WORDS

MATCH+ ONE

EXPAND PLAY

DON'T BE AFRAID TO:

WAIT LONGER

IMITATE

REPEAT

REQUEST REPETITION

ABANDON FIXED AGENDA

USE FEWER QUESTIONS

BY OBSERVING YOU MAY:

Be more sensitive to communication

Put the focus on the interaction

Try out different physical positions which are better for eye contact

BY WAITING YOU MAY:

Shift from a directive to a responsive role

Become aware of the need for the child to initiate

Let the child know that he is expected to initiate

Learn how much more the child can participate

Not anticipate the child's needs

Give the child more control over what he does, thinks, says

Learn that waiting is a strategy needed to engage the child in interaction

BY LISTENING YOU MAY:

Become aware of the need to give this child undivided attention

Become aware of and reduce environmental distractions which make it difficult for parent or child to engage in interaction

